

Travel & Transport

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NOUNS

journey

the act of travelling from one place to another

The journey took six hours by train.

destination

the place you are travelling to

Paris was their final destination after stops in Brussels and Bruges.

passport

an official document identifying a person and allowing international travel

Make sure your passport is valid for at least six months.

arrival

the act of reaching a destination

Her arrival was delayed by two hours due to a strike.

fare

the price paid for a journey on public transport

The bus fare into the city centre is one euro fifty.

carry on

a small bag or suitcase allowed in the cabin of a plane

She only travels with a carry on, no checked luggage.

layover

a stop of several hours during a longer journey, especially by air

We had a six-hour layover in Dubai on the way to Bangkok.

commute

a regular journey between home and work

Her daily commute takes ninety minutes each way.

trip

a journey, especially a short one for a specific purpose

She went on a business trip to Berlin for three days.

luggage

bags and suitcases taken on a journey

He travelled light, just one small bag of luggage.

departure

the action of leaving; the moment a journey begins

The departure time is seven-fifteen, so be there by seven.

delay

a period of time by which something is late

There was a two-hour delay on all outbound flights.

customs

the official process for checking goods brought into a country

He was stopped at customs and his bag was searched.

itinerary

a planned route or schedule for a journey

She emailed the detailed itinerary to all the group members.

turbulence

irregular air movement causing a plane to shake

The pilot warned passengers to expect turbulence over the Atlantic.

congestion

a situation in which a route is so full that movement is slow

The city centre is notorious for congestion during rush hour.

jet lag

fatigue and disorientation resulting from rapid long-distance air travel

He was still battling jet lag three days after arriving from Tokyo.

road rage

aggressive or violent behaviour by a driver towards other road users

Road rage incidents have increased significantly in urban areas.

coolcation

a holiday taken in a cooler-climate destination

More people are choosing a coolcation over a beach holiday this year.

carbon footprint

the total amount of greenhouse gases generated by a person's activities

Flying is one of the biggest contributors to an individual's carbon footprint.

tourist trap

a place that attracts many tourists and charges high prices for low quality

The waterfront was a total tourist trap, overpriced and disappointing.

sustainable tourism

travel that minimises environmental damage and supports local communities

More travellers are choosing sustainable tourism options.

ADJECTIVES

direct

(of a route) going straight to a destination without stops or changes

Is there a direct flight, or do I have to change?

scenic

(of a route or place) having beautiful or impressive natural views

They took the scenic coastal road rather than the motorway.

bumpy

(of a journey) rough and uncomfortable, with lots of jolts or shaking

It was a bumpy ride. The road was full of potholes.

stranded

unable to leave a place because of a problem such as a cancelled flight or bad weather

Hundreds of passengers were left stranded overnight when the airport closed due to fog.

remote

situated far from the main centres of population; hard to reach

The village was so remote it could only be reached on foot.

packed

(of a place or transport) extremely full of people

The train was absolutely packed. I had to stand the whole way.

smooth

(of a journey) without problems or difficulties

The crossing was smooth, no turbulence at all.

off-season

relating to the quietest and cheapest time of year for travel

We always go off-season now; it's cheaper and the beaches aren't half as crowded.

nomadic

moving from place to place without a fixed home

He had lived a nomadic lifestyle for a decade before finally settling.

VERBS

board

to get onto a plane, train, bus, or ship

Passengers began boarding twenty minutes before departure.

book

to reserve a seat, room, or ticket in advance

She booked her flights three months ahead to get a good price.

miss

to fail to catch a train, bus, or flight in time
He missed his connection and had to wait three hours.

navigate

to plan and direct a route; to find one's way through a place
She navigated her way through the backstreets entirely from memory.

embark

to board a ship or plane; to begin a new journey or project
They embarked at Southampton for the transatlantic crossing.

PHRASAL VERBS

check in

to register at an airport or hotel on arrival
You can check in online up to twenty-four hours before departure.

get in

(of a train, plane, etc.) to arrive at its destination
The train gets in at half past nine.

stop off

to make a brief visit to a place during a longer journey
We stopped off in Lyon for lunch on the way south.

take off

(of a plane) to leave the ground and begin flying
The flight took off an hour late due to a technical fault.

set off

to begin a journey
They set off at dawn to beat the traffic.

head off

to leave and begin a journey somewhere
They headed off early to avoid the motorway traffic.

get around

to travel to different places, especially within a city or region
The best way to get around the city is by metro.

venture off

to leave a safe or familiar route and explore somewhere more unknown
We ventured off the main road and found an incredible little restaurant.

COLLOCATIONS

go through customs

to pass through the official border control process
Going through customs took nearly an hour.

package holiday

an all-in-one deal in which flights, accommodation, and often meals are booked together in advance
They booked a package holiday to Crete, so the flights, hotel, and transfers were all sorted before they even left home.

annual leave

the paid holiday time an employee is entitled to take each year
I've still got eight days of annual leave to use before the end of the year.

pack light

to take only a small amount of luggage on a journey
She always packs light. One carry-on is all she ever needs.

seasoned traveller

someone who has travelled a great deal and knows how to handle unfamiliar or difficult situations calmly

As a seasoned traveller, she had the whole family through security in five minutes flat.

IDIOMS

off the beaten track

away from popular tourist routes; in a remote or unusual place

They preferred destinations off the beaten track, away from the crowds.

a hidden gem

a place or thing that is not well known but is of great quality or beauty

The restaurant was a real hidden gem, tucked away in a back street.

in the middle of nowhere

in a very remote location, far from towns or services

The car broke down in the middle of nowhere: no signal, no houses.

itchy feet

a strong desire to travel or move to a new place

She's had itchy feet since she was a teenager. She can't stay still for long.

a stone's throw

a very short distance away

The hotel was a stone's throw from the beach. You could hear the waves.

SET PHRASES

in transit

in the process of travelling from one place to another

Her luggage was lost in transit and never arrived.

MODERN SLANG

staycation

a holiday spent at home or in your own country rather than abroad

We couldn't afford to fly anywhere, so we had a staycation instead.

jet-setter

someone who travels frequently, especially to fashionable or glamorous places

Between the extra work trips and a wedding abroad, she's basically become a jet-setter this year.